



OnePlus disables 'X-Ray' filter

Reportedly, OnePlus disabled the controversial filter than can sometimes see through clothes. <https://dgit.in/jun20-32>



Deadly small cars

According to IIHS, cars with the highest death rates in their study were small and minicars. <https://dgit.in/jun20-33>

FEATURE

sails, which were triangular in shape. They were without masts, but two sides of the triangles had booms or spars (very crudely, sticks). These sails allowed the austronesians to navigate against the direction of the wind. The sails were made from woven pandanus leaves, which are resistant to salt. There is linguistic evidence that the austronesian people had contact with Indians and Sri Lankans, because of similar sounding words for sails and boats. The designs of the boats were so good that many of them continue to be in use today. The Austronesian culture established trade links with China, India, and they may even have explored as far as the western coast of the Americas. Thor Heyerdahl proposed that the Austronesians may have made the hop across the Pacific on balsa rafts, and demonstrated the possibility with the Kon Tiki voyage. The sweet potato in South America is one piece of evidence that supports the theory that Austronesians may, in fact, have crossed the pacific, but some scientists believe that the tubers could have just floated across the ocean without human intervention. In the oral history of the people, there is described a land of bitter cold in the south, which can only be Antarctica.

The information on navigation and ship building was passed on from master to apprentice, at times, across many generations of a single family. The knowledge and information was preserved through oral tradition, and these guilds may have been secretive about the techniques. Without modern instruments, the navigation was done using the Sun in the daytime and the stars at night. If the night was cloudy, then the vessels would be navigated based on the air and water currents. The Austronesians might have also used birds for navigation, as the migratory birds hop from island to island.

INDIA

The Indus Valley Civilisation had established marine trade routes with Mesopotamia (present day Iraq, Syria

and Turkey) and, in fact, there is evidence that there was a permanent Indian settlement in the region. The earliest evidence of such contact dates back to 3000 BCE. The inscriptions in Mesopotamia show that the Indian traders brought in ivory, pearls, gold, silver, rhino horns, kingfisher feathers, and wood. It is also believed that traders from both Mesopotamia and India traded goods at Bahrain, as the seals produced in Bahrain have been found in Mesopotamia and the Indus Valley. In Sumer, there are records of trade with a land known as Meluha, which is theorised to be India. Clay seals from the Indus Valley Civilisation have been found at Ur, Babylon and Kish. Researchers also believe

had. As recently as 1942, the mound over the dock was used to ship timber. The dock is a trapezoidal or fan like structure. There was an outlet channel to allow excess water to flow back into the sea, and there was a lock gate as well to ensure that there was enough water to ensure that the boats stayed afloat during low tides. Stone anchors, small model boats and seals from Bahrain have been found at the site. There is also an elevated warehouse nearby.

While it has traditionally been believed that the goods from India travelled to Europe only over land routes, there is mounting evidence to show that these goods might have travelled through sea routes as well.



The ancient dock at Lothal

that water buffalos that appear on Akkadian cylinders may have been imported from India.

In 1954, the world's oldest dock was discovered in Gujarat at the northern tip of the Gulf of Khambhat. The site was excavated over a period of five years by the Archaeological Society of India. The dock was deliberately located at a distance from the ocean currents, to prevent the deposit of sediment. The settlement is identified as Lothal, the southernmost outpost of the Indus Valley Civilisation. Even without the technical features of the dock, the choice of the location shows the advanced knowledge of sailing that the ancients

At the Red Sea, archaeologists have found a cache of about 7 kg of peppercorns, which were only available in South India in the First Century BC. Similar peppercorns have also been found in Germany. Researchers believe that sea routes to Egypt may have been used to move goods from India to Europe. The hot and dry climate of Egypt meant that the materials that have not been preserved in the subcontinent, were preserved across the Arabian Sea. These remains include baskets and fragments of sail cloth from the Indus Valley Civilisation. There are also beads found in Egypt that appear to be from Java or Thailand. Indian